

as the poem at present stands, Kalewala may be taken as an equivalent for Finland, while Lapland is represented by Pohjola.

It is worthy of observation, that the martial virtues, which alone command the admiration of most primitive poets, are but lightly esteemed in the Kalewala. The only warrior in heart and soul is Ahti or Lemminkäinen, who always brings trouble on himself and every body else, and is manifestly an inferior being to Wäinämöinen the poet, and Ilmarinen the representative of the useful arts. Most of the battles are fought, not with sword, but with song; and wild as the magical contests may be, they still imply a belief in the superiority of intellectual endowments to the possession of brute force. With all its extravagance, the Kalewala is a wild song of civilisation; and Professor Longfellow imitated not only its metre but its tendency when he wrote *Hiawatha*.

The story of the mysterious machine called the "Sampo" is supposed by Castrén to be of more recent date than that of the wooing. The nature of the Sampo itself is a matter for boundless conjecture. Some regard it as a temple which perpetuates a deity; others look upon it as an ordinary mill. Whatever it is, it brings a blessing on the land in which it is placed, and this is a blessing of peace; the materials of which it is composed,—a swan's feather, a barleycorn, a flock of wool, and a portion of milk,—clearly pointing to the different departments of agricultural employment. Castrén calls attention to the fact, that in the pursuit of the Sampo the three heroes of Kalewala appear no longer as rivals, but as patriots united for the common good of their country. Might I venture to compare this expedition with the voyage of the Argonauts:—Wäinämöinen bears a strong resemblance to Orpheus; the nature of the fleece is not wholly dissimilar to that of the Sampo; Colchis, the land of marvels, has attributes in common with Pohjola.

The sentiment which most prevails throughout the poem is that of maternal affection, which is expressed even by the wicked Louhi, and most of all by the mother of the wild Ahti, who is constantly endeavouring to check her son in his reckless undertakings. However, the marriage state is clearly regarded as one of unhappiness to the wife, and the maid who leaves the home of her parents to dwell with a husband is evidently regarded as an object of commiseration.

The concluding Rune, in which the Virgin Mary is introduced, is obviously of recent invention; but it is nevertheless exceedingly curious, as marking the transition of a people from one religion to another. The gods of Greece were stigmatised as devils by the early fathers of the Church; but the old Finnish mythology is more gently treated. Wäinämöinen is not allowed to ascend to the Christian heaven, when the reign of the Redeemer is proclaimed; but he is still raised above earth, and his harp still remains as a relic of the blessings he conferred upon his race.